



A COMMUNITY OF CHOICE

PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT SERVICES

URBAN PLANNING OFFICE

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GRANT AWARD RESOLUTION STAFF REPORT

Façade Improvement Program Grant

RESOLUTION: First Reading, April 8, 2013
Finance Committee, April 15, 2013
Second Reading, April 22, 2013

PREPARED BY: Jim Flesher, Senior Planner

RECOMMENDATION: The Urban Planning Office recommends acceptance of the grant.

The Wyoming State Historic Preservation Office (SHPO) has approved an application for a Certified Local Government (CLG) grant to fund hiring a consultant to help develop a program to aid in restoration and maintenance of historic Downtown façades. The consultant will work with City staff, the Cheyenne Historic Preservation Board, the Downtown Development Authority, and others to produce a report identifying potential strategies and recommending an appropriate structure for such a Façade Improvement Program. This grant will not itself fund restoration of façades, but will serve to develop the program, identify funding sources, and suggest how to select or prioritize buildings for future façade improvement assistance.

A Façade Improvement Program, if implemented, could provide financial assistance to owners of historic downtown buildings for maintaining or restoring building façades that contribute to the historic significance and character of Downtown Cheyenne and are an asset to the entire community. Such assistance could help attract new businesses to vacant or underutilized Downtown buildings, promote preservation of significant historic structures, and increase property values and tax revenue to the City.

CLG grants are 60 percent federally funded with a 40 percent match; however, the value of staff and volunteer (Board member) time is allowed to be counted for the required match, as is the value of meeting space provided for public meetings. The award amount is \$7,000.

RESOLUTION NO. _____

ENTITLED: “A RESOLUTION AUTHORIZING THE MAYOR AND CITY CLERK TO EXECUTE A STATE HISTORIC PRESERVATION OFFICE CERTIFIED LOCAL GOVERNMENT (CLG) GRANT AGREEMENT IN ORDER TO DEVELOP A DOWNTOWN CHEYENNE FAÇADE IMPROVEMENT PROGRAM.”

WHEREAS, Section 2.64.020(A) of the Cheyenne City Code provides as follows: “The governing body recognizes that many areas, improvements and landscape features have historic character or special historical or aesthetic interest or value and many improvements representing the finest architectural products or distinct periods in the history of Cheyenne. It is declared a matter of public policy that the protection, enhancement and perpetuation of areas, improvements and landscape features having historic character or special historical or aesthetic interest or value is a public necessity and is required in the interest of the people.”; and

WHEREAS, according to the National Park Service, “the CLG Program integrates local governments with the national historic preservation program through activities that strengthen decision-making regarding historic places at the local level”; and

WHEREAS, according to the State Historic Preservation Office (SHPO), “the Wyoming SHPO strives to help local communities achieve their preservation goals, for it is at the local level that preservation efforts are often the most effective”; and

WHEREAS, many building façades in the Downtown Cheyenne area contribute to the historic significance and character of Downtown Cheyenne and are an asset to the entire community; and

WHEREAS, a façade improvement program could help protect historic building façades in the Downtown Cheyenne area and upgrade underutilized or vacant buildings to attract new businesses and residential uses; and

WHEREAS, SHPO has awarded the City of Cheyenne Historic Preservation Board a grant in the amount of \$7,000 in order to fund a project designed to develop a strategy for creating and implementing a Downtown Cheyenne Façade Improvement Program.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE, Wyoming, that the City of Cheyenne is hereby authorized to accept the said grant award in the amount of \$7,000.00 from the SHPO to be used solely for the Façade Improvement Program project.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Mayor and City Clerk are authorized to execute all documents relating to the grant upon approval of this resolution.

PRESENTED, READ, AND ADOPTED ON THIS _____ DAY OF _____, 2013.

SEAL:
ATTEST:

Richard L. Kaysen, Mayor

Carol Intlekofer, City Clerk